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ARGOMENTO	Grammar and Cloud

Here are the **most common grammar features** you'll see in the **cloud computing / cloud systems sector**, especially in docs, specs, tickets, and technical communication.

Key structure	Function
Passive	Used when the focus is on the system, process, or data, not the person.
Modal Verbs	Used in requirements, configurations, and policies.
Conditional Sentences (If-clauses)	Used for system behavior, troubleshooting, automation.
Imperatives	Very common in guides, CLI usage, and procedures.
Noun Stacking (Compound Nouns)	Multiple nouns used together as adjectives.
Present Simple	Used to describe how systems generally work.
Future	*Will* (automatic results) - *Going to* (planned actions).
Relative Clauses	Used to explain components and services.

Gerunds (-ing forms) After Prepositions	Very common in documentation.
Formal & Impersonal Structures (There is; It is + adj + to)	Cloud documentation sounds formal and neutral.
Technical Comparatives & Superlatives	Used when comparing services or performance.
Acronyms Used as Nouns (Grammar Adaptation)	Acronyms behave like regular nouns in sentences.

EXERCISES:

Ex.1 - Passive Voice

Conjugate the verbs in brackets into the correct passive tense.

1. Data _____ (store) in multiple regions.
2. The servers _____ (monitor) right now by the DevOps team.
3. Unusual traffic _____ (detect) by the system this morning.
4. Firewall rules _____ (update) tomorrow.
5. A detailed report _____ (generate) by the script.
6. The database _____ (migrate) next week.
7. A new version _____ (deploy) when the outage occurred.
8. The issue _____ (resolve) before users noticed it.
9. Millions of requests _____ (process) every minute.
10. The network _____ (scan) at the moment.
11. The backup _____ (complete) by midnight.
12. Sensitive files _____ (access) during the breach.
13. All sensitive data _____ (encrypt) to ensure compliance.
14. Alerts _____ (send) automatically since the update.
15. Logs _____ (store) in the cloud for years before the migration.

Ex. 2 - Modal Verbs (Obligation, Advice, Possibility)

Choose the correct modal: **must / mustn't / should / shouldn't / can / can't / may / might**

1. Users _____ enable multi-factor authentication.
2. You _____ share your API key with others.
3. This error _____ occur during deployment.
4. You _____ check the logs before restarting the server.
5. Instances _____ be resized at any time.
6. You _____ ignore security warnings.
7. Data _____ be recovered from snapshots.
8. Administrators _____ review access permissions regularly.
9. The issue _____ be caused by a network failure.
10. You _____ use weak passwords.
11. The system _____ automatically scale during peak traffic.
12. Developers _____ test the application before release.
13. This configuration _____ improve performance.
14. You _____ disable encryption in production.
15. The delay _____ be due to high latency.

Ex. 3 - Conditionals (Zero, First, Second, Third)

Put the verbs in the correct conditional form.

1. If a VM _____ (stop), it _____ (not consume) CPU.
2. If traffic increases, the system _____ (scale) automatically.
3. If you _____ (not configure) backups, you risk data loss.
4. If the server crashes, the system _____ (restart) it.
5. If users _____ (forget) their password, they can reset it.
6. If we _____ (have) more budget, we would upgrade the servers.
7. If the company _____ (use) auto-scaling, it would save money.
8. If I were the admin, I _____ (enable) logging.
9. If they had updated the system, the breach _____ (not happen).
10. If we had created a snapshot, we _____ (recover) the data.
11. If the firewall had been configured correctly, attackers _____ (be) blocked.
12. If latency increases, performance _____ (decrease).
13. If you mix public and private keys, authentication _____ (fail).
14. If I had known about the vulnerability, I _____ (patch) it earlier.
15. If encryption is disabled, data _____ (be) at risk.

Ex. 4 - Imperatives (Instructions)

Rewrite as **clear commands**.

1. You should configure the DNS settings.
2. You must restart the container.
3. You need to check the server logs.
4. You should create a backup first.
5. You must update the system.
6. You need to monitor CPU usage.
7. You should enable encryption.
8. You must verify user permissions.
9. You need to install the latest patch.
10. You should test the API endpoint.
11. You must review the firewall rules.
12. You should deploy the new version.
13. You need to stop the instance.
14. You should document the configuration.
15. You must remove unused accounts.

Ex. 5 - Noun Stacking (Compound Nouns)

Before starting:

What it is:

Noun stacking happens when **two or more nouns are placed together** to act as **a single noun phrase**.
In English, this is very common in technical writing because it **compresses information** into short, precise expressions.

Structure:

[Noun] + [Noun] (+ [Noun] …)

- The **first noun(s)** describe or modify the **last noun**, which is the main object.
- The **last noun** is the head of the phrase, the "main thing."
- No articles ("a / the") are usually used between nouns.

Examples: Data Storage system; Cloud security policy.

How to read them:

1. Start from the **rightmost noun** → main thing.
2. Each noun to the **left modifies** the main noun.
3. Often used to make **technical writing concise**.

Example:

- CONTAINER ORCHESTRATION TOOL → a **tool** (main noun) for **orchestrating containers**.

Tips

- **Too long?** If there are **4+ nouns**, consider using "of" for clarity:
  - `cloud infrastructure provider service` → `service of a cloud infrastructure provider`
- **Plural nouns** usually appear **only at the end**:
  - Correct: `API request limit`
  - Avoid: `APIs request limit`

How to order nouns in a stack

Rule of Thumb:

1. **The rightmost noun is the main noun** – the "thing" you are talking about.
2. **Nouns to the left act as adjectives** – they describe or limit the main noun.
3. **Order modifiers from general → specific**: the **first noun is more general**, the one closer to the main noun is more specific.

Step-by-Step Example

Words: `cloud / security / policy`

1. Identify the **main noun** → What is the "thing"?
    - `policy` → yes, the main object.
2. Decide **which noun is more general / which is more specific**:
    - `cloud` → general context (applies to cloud systems)
    - `security` → specific aspect (focuses on security)
3. Arrange **general → specific → main noun**:
    - **cloud security policy** ✅

Another Example: `application / deployment / pipeline`

1. Main noun → `pipeline` (it's the thing)
2. What describes the pipeline? → `deployment` (type of pipeline)
3. More general context → `application` (what is being deployed)
4. Stack: **application deployment pipeline** ✅

Quick Tips

1. **Think: "Which noun answers the question 'what kind of …?'"**
    - `What kind of pipeline?` → deployment
    - `What kind of deployment pipeline?` → application
2. **Context matters** – sometimes you reorder for clarity:
    - `database backup solution` → solution for backing up databases
    - `backup database solution` ❌ sounds odd
3. **Optional adjectives**:
   Sometimes a noun can act like a **regular adjective**:

    - `server performance monitoring` → monitoring (main) of server performance (modifiers)
4. **Practice makes perfect** – start by identifying **main noun** → **most specific modifier** → **more general modifier**.

Ex. 5 - Noun Stacking Exercise – Cloud Computing

Tidy the following nouns.

1. data / storage / system → _____
2. cloud / security / policy → _____
3. user / access / control → _____
4. network / traffic / analysis → _____
5. server / performance / monitoring → _____
6. application / deployment / pipeline → _____
7. system / error / message → _____
8. resource / usage / report → _____
9. identity / management / service → _____
10. database / backup / solution → _____

Ex 6 - Present Simple

Complete with the **present simple**.

1. The system _____ (store) data securely.
2. The platform _____ (run) in multiple regions.
3. The API _____ (return) a JSON response.
4. The firewall _____ (block) suspicious traffic.
5. The service _____ (scale) automatically.
6. The tool _____ (monitor) performance.
7. The system _____ (log) all requests.
8. The database _____ (replicate) data.
9. The server _____ (handle) user requests.
10. The application _____ (connect) to the cloud.
11. The platform _____ (support) multiple users.
12. The system _____ (detect) anomalies.
13. The tool _____ (generate) reports.
14. The network _____ (transfer) data packets.
15. The service _____ (provide) secure access.

Ex. 7 - Future Forms (Will / Going to)

Choose **will** or **going to**.

1. The system _____ generate an alert automatically.
2. We _____ migrate the database next week.
3. The backup _____ start at midnight.
4. They _____ deploy a new version tomorrow.
5. The platform _____ scale during high traffic.
6. We _____ upgrade the servers this weekend.
7. The system _____ send a notification.
8. The team _____ test the new feature.
9. The tool _____ detect performance issues.
10. We _____ move to a hybrid cloud model.
11. The script _____ run after deployment.
12. They _____ redesign the network architecture.
13. The monitoring system _____ trigger an alarm.
14. We _____ implement a new security policy.
15. The service _____ restart automatically.

Ex 8 - Relative Clauses

Combine the sentences using **who / which / that**.

1. A load balancer is a service. It distributes traffic.
2. Snapshots are backups. They can be restored later.
3. Users forget their password. They must reset it.
4. The server is down. It hosts the database.
5. This is the tool. It monitors performance.
6. The engineer fixed the bug. He works on security.
7. We use a platform. It supports auto-scaling.
8. The file was deleted. It contained logs.
9. The admin manages accounts. She works remotely.
10. The API failed. It handles payments.
11. The company offers a service. It provides cloud storage.
12. The system detected an attack. It was very advanced.
13. The database crashed. It stores customer data.
14. The user reported an issue. He uses the mobile app.
15. The script runs daily. It cleans temporary files.

Ex. 9 - Gerunds After Prepositions

Use the **-ing form** of the verb.

1. After _____ (deploy) the app, restart the server.
2. Before _____ (update) the system, create a backup.
3. By _____ (using) encryption, you protect data.
4. Without _____ (configure) IAM roles, access is denied.
5. Instead of _____ (upgrade) the server, we replaced it.
6. After _____ (install) the patch, reboot the machine.
7. Before _____ (connect) to the database, check credentials.
8. By _____ (monitor) traffic, you detect threats.
9. Without _____ (enable) logging, you can't track errors.
10. After _____ (create) a snapshot, test the restore process.
11. Instead of _____ (store) data locally, use the cloud.
12. Before _____ (run) the script, verify the configuration.
13. By _____ (automate) tasks, you save time.
14. Without _____ (update) the software, vulnerabilities remain.
15. After _____ (fix) the bug, deploy the update.

Ex. 10 - Formal & Impersonal Structures

Rewrite using **There is/There are** or **It is + adjective + to**.

1. Enabling logging is important.
2. Several risks exist in cloud environments.
3. Using strong passwords is essential.
4. Many ways exist to protect data.
5. Securing APIs is necessary.
6. A possibility of data loss exists.
7. Monitoring systems regularly is recommended.
8. Multiple solutions are available.
9. Encrypting sensitive data is important.
10. A delay in processing exists.
11. Reviewing access rights is advisable.
12. Several vulnerabilities are in the system.
13. Backing up data frequently is essential.
14. A need for better security exists.
15. Reducing downtime is important.

Ex. 11 - Comparatives & Superlatives

Use the correct **comparative or superlative** form.

1. This solution is _____ (fast) than the old one.
2. Object storage is _____ (scalable) than local storage.
3. This is the _____ (secure) configuration.
4. The new server is _____ (powerful) than the previous one.
5. This tool is the _____ (efficient) in our system.
6. Cloud hosting is _____ (flexible) than on-premise hosting.
7. This is the _____ (reliable) backup method.
8. The latest version is _____ (stable) than the beta version.
9. That provider is the _____ (popular) in the market.
10. This firewall is _____ (effective) than the old one.
11. It's the _____ (good) option for startups.
12. This region is _____ (expensive) than others.
13. The new architecture is the _____ (complex).
14. This database is _____ (fast) than the legacy system.
15. That was the _____ (bad) outage of the year.

Ex. 12 - Acronyms as Nouns (Singular/Plural)

Choose the correct form (singular/plural + verb agreement).

1. The _____ (API/APIs) is not responding.
2. Several _____ (VM/VMs) were deployed.
3. The _____ (CPU/CPUs) is overheating.
4. Multiple _____ (IP/IPs) were blocked.
5. The _____ (URL/URLs) is incorrect.
6. Two _____ (DB/DBs) are running.
7. The _____ (OS/OSs) needs an update.
8. Many _____ (SDK/SDKs) support this feature.
9. The _____ (GPU/GPUs) is used for AI workloads.
10. Several _____ (ID/IDs) were generated.
11. The _____ (DNS/DNSs) is misconfigured.
12. Multiple _____ (SSH key/SSH keys) were added.
13. The _____ (SSL certificate/SSL certificates) has expired.
14. Several _____ (CLI/CLIs) are available.
15. The _____ (IoT device/IoT devices) is offline.